



As your body changes, you will want a comfortable **pregnancy wardrobe** that offers **flexibility** and **comfort aids** and props to help you to sleep and ease pregnancy complaints. You should also start buying **equipment** for **life after the birth**.

Practical tips for Mom

Do I need a maternity wardrobe?

Being comfortable is key during pregnancy. In the early months when your waistband first expands, you may get away with wearing normal clothes in a larger size or borrowing your partner's tops, but for most women this isn't a solution that will work for long. Clothes designed for pregnancy use fabrics and cuts that expand in the right places as you get bigger, whereas regular clothes may simply become tighter and uncomfortable. It can seem wasteful to splurge on maternity clothes that you will wear for a brief period only, but they will see a lot of use for five or six months and will get you through any future pregnancies, too, so it is worth a little investment. Happily, it is possible to assemble a decent maternity wardrobe on a budget by borrowing them or buying them secondhand.

Keeping in season

When you start to assemble your maternity wardrobe, think about what time of year it will be toward the end of your pregnancy. If your early pregnancy is in the summer months, you may not want to spend on maternity summer

dresses or short-sleeved blouses that will see little use when you need bigger sizes. And likewise, you won't want a collection of long-sleeved, warm maternity tops if you are going to be heavily pregnant in the middle of the summer. You may be able to pick up some bargains in end-of-season sales that will be perfect in six months time.

A little support

Your growing belly can also cause pregnancy complaints such as backaches, which means that getting a good night's sleep becomes increasingly difficult. Even sitting can become uncomfortable in the latter stages of pregnancy. Props such as pillows and belly support bands can be invaluable now, and some support pillows double up as nursing pillows. You may also want to consider an exercise ball, which is useful before, during, and after the birth, and inflatable cushions and pillows that can make sitting easier if you're suffering with hemorrhoids—a common pregnancy complaints—or want to avoid putting pressure on any stitches you may have after the birth.